Appendix 3. Search strategy

1. In PubMed
   Initial search using “Caries AND Disability”
   Total: 1066 titles

   Different combinations of MeSH terms, limits and Boolean operators were tested, to define those that could include the highest number of relevant publications.
   The final strategy used was:
   "Dental Caries/therapy"[Mesh] AND ("Dental Care for Disabled"[Mesh] OR "Disabled Persons"[Mesh] OR "Disabled Children"[Mesh] OR "Mentally Disabled Persons"[Mesh] OR "Communication Aids for Disabled"[Mesh]) NOT ("Periodontal Diseases"[Mesh] NOT "Surgery, Oral"[Mesh] NOT "Editorial"[Publication Type] NOT "Letter "[Publication Type] NOT "Case Reports"[Publication Type] NOT "Review"[Publication Type]) AND (hasabstract[text] AND (Clinical Trial[ptyp] OR Randomized Controlled Trial[ptyp] OR Clinical Trial, Phase I[ptyp] OR Clinical Trial, Phase II[ptyp] OR Clinical Trial, Phase III[ptyp] OR Clinical Trial, Phase IV[ptyp] OR Controlled Clinical Trial[ptyp] OR English Abstract[ptyp] OR Journal Article[ptyp]) AND (English[lang] OR French[lang] OR German[lang] OR Spanish[lang] OR Portuguese[lang]) AND ("2011/02/01"[PDAT]: "2022/04/01"[PDAT])).
   Total: 32 titles

2. In Lilacs
   Terms “Caries” AND “Disability” were used to search for relevant publications
   Total: 80 titles

3. In the Cochrane Library database for randomized clinical trials
   Terms “Caries AND Disability” ------≥ search for trials ------≥ filtered by “years” from 01/02/2011 to 01/04/2022
   Total: 66 titles